Nimbus backups and restore verification

Version: 2026.2. Effective date: 2026-09-01. Owner: Storage Reliability.

Access scope: workshop-public. Supersedes previous-policy.md.

Applicability

Nimbus production relational databases; customer export jobs are separate from backups.

Backup schedule

Take an encrypted full backup every 24 hours and archive transaction logs every 15 minutes. Keep backup restore points for 35 calendar days in a separate administrative account. Monitor backup age and archive failures continuously.

Recovery objectives

The design recovery-point objective is 15 minutes and the design recovery-time objective is four hours after restore authorization. These are engineering objectives, not guarantees. The actual recoverable point depends on verified backup and transaction-log availability.

Restore authorization

The service owner and incident commander approve a production restore. Restore first into an isolated environment, validate schema, row counts, application checks, and customer-impact scope, then record the cutover decision. Never overwrite the only surviving copy during investigation.

Exercises and exceptions

Run a sample restore monthly and record selected backup ID, achieved recovery point, elapsed restore time, and validation results. A successful backup job does not prove restore readiness. Legal holds under source-18 may require separately preserved records; the 35-day rolling backup window is not a substitute. Source-34 explains deletion and backup aging.

Related document: operational-record.md supplements this source; read its record type and effective period before applying it.

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